

Chapter-10

The Conjunction

Study carefully how the following pairs of sentences are joined.

1. He bought apples. He bought mangoes.
He bought apples **and** mangoes.
2. My brother is tall. I am short.
My brother is tall **but** I am short.
3. He is ill. He cannot come to school
He is ill, **so** he cannot come to school.
He cannot come to school **because** he is ill.

You can observe that in each pair of sentences given above, two different statements are given. These two different statements are joined by using the words 'and', 'but', 'so' and 'because'. These words which join two words or clauses are called conjunctions, connectors or linkers.

Conjunction: A word which is used to join two words, phrases or clauses is called a conjunction.

Kinds of Conjunction

1. Coordinative Conjunctions: A Coordinative Conjunction joins the grammatical units of the same type or equal status e.g. nouns with noun, adjective with adjective, phrase with phrase and clause with clause. It joins words, phrases or clauses of equal status. In a compound Sentence, it joins two coordinate Clauses. Examples: and, but, for, or, still, yet, so, therefore, as well as, otherwise, else, only etc.

- ♦ I went home. I changed my clothes.
I went home and changed my clothes. (Joins verb with verb)
- ♦ Take care of your health. You will fall ill.
Take care of your health, otherwise you will fall ill. (Joins two coordinate clauses)
- ♦ He likes ice-cream. He does not like juice.
He likes ice-cream, but not juice. (Joins noun with noun)

2. Subordinating Conjunction: A subordinating conjunction joins subordinate clause/clauses to the principal clause in a complex sentence.

Examples: unless, until, because, since, as, if, whether, before, after, when, while, where, wherever etc.

- ♦ I used to play cricket when I was a student.
- ♦ He ran away because he was afraid.

The underlined clauses in the above sentences are Subordinate Clauses.

3. Correlative Conjunctions: Correlative conjunctions also join grammatical units of the same type or equal status e.g. nouns with noun, adjective with adjective, phrase with phrase and clause with clause. Correlative conjunctions are followed by the same part of speech. They are always used in pairs.

Examples: Both.....and, Either.....or, Neither.....nor, Hardly.....when, Scarcely.....before, Not only.....but also etc.

- ♦ He is either a fool (noun) or a rogue (noun).
- ♦ Hardly had he reached school (clause) when the peon rang the bell. (clause)

4. Compound Conjunctions: Compound conjunctions are groups of words that function as conjunctions. Some expressions or phrases act as conjunctions.

- ♦ He will lend you money provided that you return it on time.
- ♦ I will let you play in my garden on condition that you do not pluck the flowers.
- ♦ The thief ran away as soon as he heard a noise.

These expressions or phrases are called Compound Conjunctions.

Exercise: Underline the conjunctions in the following sentences.

1. Rohit and Riya went to market.
2. I bought vegetables but I did not buy fruit.
3. You can wait here or go home.
4. I cannot buy this house because I do not have enough money.
5. He is very weak, so he cannot walk.
6. I will attend the party if you invite me.
7. I will watch TV when I have finished my homework.
8. He failed, for he had not worked hard.
9. He was tired, yet he continued his work.
10. I know that you have helped him with money.
11. Tell me why he has shifted to Delhi.
12. Think before you speak.
13. He has not called me since he shifted to his new house.
14. This is the house which my father built.
15. Although he was alone at house, he was not afraid.

Types of Coordinative Conjunctions

1. Cumulative or Copulative Conjunctions: Cumulative conjunctions add or connect words, phrases or clauses of the same type, status or level. They are used to convey the idea of similarity between the units being joined. Examples: and, also, too, as well as, both.....and, not only.....but also etc.

Examples: Read the pair of sentences given below.

He is smart. He is intelligent.

In the above pair of sentences, we come to know about two qualities of 'He'. Since both the qualities are positive and don't show any contradiction, we will join the above pair of sentences using a cumulative conjunction.

Examples:

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. He is smart and intelligent. | 4. He is both smart and intelligent. |
| 2. He is smart as well as intelligent. | 5. He is smart; and intelligent also . |
| 3. He is smart; and intelligent too . | 6. He is not only smart but also intelligent. |

2. Adversative Conjunctions: These conjunctions are used to connect or join two contradictory, contrasting or opposite ideas. Examples: but, still, however, nevertheless, only, whereas, yet

Example: Read the pair of sentences given below.

He is intelligent. He is not hard working.

He is intelligent, but not hardworking.

Examples:

- He is poor **but** honest.
- He was weak; **still** he managed to walk for long.
- He lost everything in life; **however** he started his life anew with a strong will.
- Everyone in the family opposed him; **nevertheless** he chased his dreams.
- Do what you like, **only** don't disturb me.
- My friend is tall **whereas** his brother is not (tall).
- He has a lot of wealth, **yet** he is a miser.

3. Disjunctive or Alternative Conjunction: These conjunctions express a choice between two words, phrases or clauses. Examples: or, nor, either.....or, neither.....nor, otherwise, else

Examples:

- Run fast, **or** you will lose the race.
- You can **either** wait **or** go.
- He is **neither** intelligent **nor** hardworking.
- Work hard, **otherwise** you will fail.
- Return these books on time, **else** you will be fined.

4. Illative Conjunctions: When a fact or statement is inferred or provided from another statement, the two of them are joined by using an illative coordinating conjunctions. Examples: so, hence, therefore, for, then

Examples:

- My foot was injured, **so** I could not walk.
- It had been raining since morning; **hence** we could not go out.
- He is not well today; **therefore** he cannot come to school.
- He missed the train, **for** he was late.
- We are getting late, let's hurry up **then**.

Important Note: Remember the Acronym FANBOYS to remember some important conjunctions.

F= for

A=and, as well as

N=neither.....nor

B=but

O=or, otherwise, else

Y=yet, still

S=so, hence, therefore

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with suitable conjunctions

1. I called himhe did not receive my call.
2. She is neither a teacher..... a doctor.
3. Her condition was serious,she was admitted to a hospital.
4. You must go home now,.....you will be late.
5. She isbeautiful and intelligent.
6. He failed,he had not worked hard.
7. Sit wherever you want,don't sit here.
8. I am thin my brother is fat.
9. He suffered a great loss,.....he did not lose hope.
10. He is very rich,.....he is humble.

Exercise: Join the following pairs of sentences using the conjunctions given in the brackets.

1. They were late. They managed to catch the train. (however)

.....

2. He is underweight. He cannot participate in this competition. (therefore)

.....

3. I like chocolate. I like cake. (both.....and)

4. Wear a sweater. You will get cold. (else)

5. He worked hard. He could not qualify for the post. (nevertheless)

6. He has solved the sum. His brother has solved the sum. (either.....or)

7. The weather was cold and wet. We had a great time. (still)

8. Deposit your fee by tomorrow. Your name will be struck off. (or)

9. He does not exercise regularly. He has put on weight. (hence)

10. He is not a producer. He is not a director. (neither.....nor)

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with Conjunctions of Time by choosing the correct option.

1. Look(before/after) you leap.
2. I will go to play.....(before/after) I have finished my work.
3. I used to play cricket.....(when/till) I was a student.
4. Make hay.....(before/while) the sun shines.
5. I haven't seen her.....(since/when) she left her job.
6. Wait here.....(till/when) I come.
7. I waited for my friend.....(till/until) he came.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with conjunctions by choosing the correct option.

1. He will follow you.....you go. (when/wherever)
2. I kept the books..... you told me to keep. (when/where)
3. Tell me the placeyou parked your car. (where/ since)
4. They worked.....I had instructed. (as/ since)
5. He walked..... he were lame. (as if/ if)
6. He died.....he could not get proper treatment. (because/so)
7. I will lead this project..... you want me to do it. (since/hence)
8. We left a message for him.....he was not at home. (so/as)
9. You can stand first in the class.....you work hard. (if/unless)
10. You will not stand first in the class.....you work hard. (if/unless)
11. He is.....(so/as) weak that he cannot walk.
12. He worked hard..... he might pass the examination. (so that/so)
13. Run fastyou should miss the train. (lest/as)
14.he is poor, he is honest. (because/though)
15. You have to eat ityou like it or not. (whether/unless)

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with suitable conjunction.

1. Strike the iron.....it is hot.
2. He was playing.....his father came home.
3.you start early, you will catch the train.
4.they batted badly, they won the match.
5. It's been a month.....she came here.
6. I shall wait for you.....you return.
7. I must believe ityou say so.
8. Cooperate with him,you like it or not.
9. He took a short cut.....he might save time.
10. She pretendedshe were the princess.

Exercise: Join the following pairs of sentences using conjunctions given in the brackets.

1. He is ill. He will attend the meeting. (though)
.....
2. He walked very fast. He seemed to be in a hurry. (as if)
.....
3. He would not surrender. You beat him black and blue. (even if)
.....
4. She is a good singer. She is not a good dancer. (but)
.....
5. You will not lose. You do not accept your defeat. (unless)
.....
6. He was caught. He was stealing the money. (while)
.....
7. The child was crying. The child was hungry. (because)
.....
8. You like something. Do it. (as)
.....
9. He should leave early. He will miss the train. (unless)
.....
10. There is life. There is hope. (as long as)
.....

Types of Subordinating Conjunctions

Subordinating functions may be divided according to their meaning or function.

1. Time: Before, as, after, when, while, since, as soon as, till, until, so long as, as long as, now that, once etc.

Examples:

- ♦ Look before you leap.
- ♦ I will go to play after I have finished my work.
- ♦ I used to play cricket when I was a student.
- ♦ I haven't seen her since she left her job.
- ♦ Wait here till I come.

2. Place: Where, wherever, whence

- ♦ He will follow you wherever you go.
- ♦ I kept the books where you told me to keep.
- ♦ They returned whence they had come.

3. Manner or Extent: as, so far as, as if, as though, as far as etc.

- ♦ They worked as I had instructed.
- ♦ So far as his health is concerned, he is better now.
- ♦ As far as his behaviour is concerned, he has shown improvement.
- ♦ He walked as if he were lame.
- ♦ It sounds as though you had a good time.

4. Cause: Because, since, as

- ♦ He died because he could not get proper treatment.
- ♦ I will lead this project since you want me to do it.

5. Condition: Provided, provided that, on condition that, if, in case, unless, supposing, h

- ♦ You can stand first in the class provided you work hard.
- ♦ You can stand first in the class provided that you work hard.
- ♦ You can stand first in the class if you work hard.
- ♦ You will not stand first in the class unless you work hard.

6. Result or Effect: so.....that

- ♦ He is so weak that he cannot walk.

7. Purpose: that, so that, in order that, lest.....should, for fear that

- ♦ He worked hard so that he might pass the examination.
- ♦ He is working hard in order that he may pass the examination.
- ♦ Run fast lest you should miss the train.
- ♦ We eat that we may live.

8. Contrast or Concession: though, although, notwithstanding, as, even if, whether, however, whatever, while, when

- ♦ Though he is poor, he is honest. He is honest though he is poor.
- ♦ Although he is poor, he is honest. He is honest although he is poor.
- ♦ You have to eat it whether you like it or not.
- ♦ Whatever happens, I will fight till the end.
- ♦ While he is good at science, his brother is hopeless.

9. Comparison: than, as

- ♦ My brother is taller than I am.
- ♦ Ramesh ran faster than Suresh. (did).

Correlative Conjunctions

1. **Both.....and** (Used to join similar things/concepts)
 - He is both a lyricist and composer.
2. **Either.....or** (Used to choose/select either of two choices)
 - You can take either a bus or a train for Delhi.
3. **Neither.....nor** (Used to reject either of the two choices)
 - He is neither a doctor nor a lawyer.
4. **Hardly.....when** (Used in the sense of 'as soon as')
 - Hardly had I stepped out of my house when it started raining.
5. **Scarcely.....when/before** (Used in the sense of 'as soon as')
 - I scarcely had time to ring the bell before the door opened
 - He had scarcely reached school when the peon rang the bell.
6. **Not only.....but also** (Used in the sense of 'and' or 'in addition to')
 - He not only invited me, but also gave me a beautiful gift.
7. **No sooner.....than** (Used in the sense of 'as soon as')
 - No sooner did the thief see the police than he ran away.
 - No sooner had I reached home than it started raining.
8. **Though.....yet** (Used to express contrast)
 - Though the baby is weak yet it is active. Or,
 - Though the baby is weak, it is active.
9. **Although.....yet** (Used to express contrast)
 - Although he worked hard yet he could not succeed. Or,
 - Although he worked hard, he could not succeed.
10. **So.....that** (Used to show result or effect)
 - He is so intelligent that he can solve these sums easily.
11. **Whether.....or** (Used to join two contrasting ideas)
 - You should work under him, whether you like him or not.
12. **Lest.....should** (Used in the sense of 'otherwise')
 - Walk fast lest you should miss the train.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with pairs of conjunctions:

1. This book is.....usefulcheap.
2.my brother.....my sister went to school today.
3. You can.....play.....work.
4. This boy can.....hear.....speak.
5. Be careful.....you.....repent later.
6.Girish.....his brother are intelligent.
7. He workedhardhe won a scholarship.
8. It is all the same for me.....you stay here.....go back home.
9.he is poor.....he is honest.
10.did the teacher enter the classthe students became silent.

Exercise: Rewrite the following sentences by correcting the errors.

1. He is a poet but novelist.
2. She is very beautiful and proud.
3. I have not met her when she left the office.
4. Make hay before the sun shines.
5. You cannot succeed if you work hard.
6. Either John nor his brother has broken the window.
7. The tea is very hot that I cannot drink it.
8. Follow the rules and you will be terminated.
9. He is rich and arrogant.
10. He did not come to school, so he was ill.
11. Rajat is not only hardworking but loyal.
12. She is neither studying or playing.
13. I do not know that when she will go.
14. Walk carefully lest you must fall.
15. You will not catch the train unless you do not hurry up.
16. Wait here after the train arrives.
17. It was raining heavily so that he was late.
18. The little child was lost in the forest and he did not lose heart.
19. I got the book when I left it.
20. She cannot read nor write.